

Modern Horizons 3 Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

MTGNET

July 4, 2026

Dataset Snapshot

This run uses 163,693 unique deck builds and 767,772 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 9 learned archetypes. The best-performing large shells are Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith, Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible, Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and build-around incentives.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	22,384	109,504	58.47%	Conduit Goblin, Hexgold Slith, Solstice Zealot, Smelted Chargebug, Mandibular Kite
Gruul Eldrazi Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	21,713	108,250	57.96%	Writhing Chrysalis, Glimpse the Impossible, Voidpouncer, Malevolent Rumble, Eldrazi Repurposer
Azorius Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire	12,371	57,669	55.60%	Riddle Gate Gargoyle, Emissary of Soulfire, Solstice Zealot, Tune the Narrative, Electrozoa
Selesnya Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	14,069	66,943	55.29%	Faithful Watchdog, Aerie Auxiliary, Nyxborn Unicorn, Dog Umbra, Mandibular Kite
Dimir Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	15,741	72,303	54.71%	Sneaky Snacker, Kami of Jealous Thirst, Eviscerator's Insight, Mindless Conscription, Breathe Your Last

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	28,695	135,385	53.68%	Snapping Voidcraw, Drownyard Lurker, Sage of the Unknowable, Petrifying Meddler, Unfathomable Truths
Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	12,275	54,747	53.35%	Cyclops Superconductor, Tune the Narrative, Aether Spike, Tempest Harvester, Electrozoa
Rakdos Zombies Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	13,078	58,312	53.11%	Cranial Ram, Refurbished Familiar, Drossclaw, Retrofitted Transmogrator, Sarpadian Simulacrum
Black Base Dreamdrinker Vampire / Wither and Bloom	23,367	104,659	52.32%	Dreamdrinker Vampire, Wither and Bloom, Expanding Ooze, Breathe Your Last, Fetid Gargantua

2 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith

This cluster contains 22,384 decks across 109,504 games and posts a baseline win rate of 58.47%. Its defining cards are Conduit Goblin, Hexgold Slith, Solstice Zealot, Smelted Chargebug, Mandibular Kite, Scurry of Gremlins.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible

This cluster contains 21,713 decks across 108,250 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.96%. Its defining cards are Writhing Chrysalis, Glimpse the Impossible, Voidpouncer, Malevolent Rumble, Eldrazi Repurposer, Horrific Assault.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire

This cluster contains 12,371 decks across 57,669 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.60%. Its defining cards are Riddle Gate Gargoyle, Emissary of Soulfire, Solstice Zealot, Tune the Narrative, Electrozoa, Aether Spike.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Selesnya | Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary

This cluster contains 14,069 decks across 66,943 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.29%. Its defining cards are Faithful Watchdog, Aerie Auxiliary, Nyxborn Unicorn, Dog Umbra, Mandibular Kite, Golden-Tail Trainer.

The strongest positive links in the shell are Evolution Witness + Metastatic Evangel. The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

3 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Crabomination	Dimir Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	14.10 pp	68.80%	3196
Amped Raptor	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	10.50 pp	63.84%	5493
Fury	Gruul Eldrazi Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	10.34 pp	68.31%	183
Guide of Souls	Azorius Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire	10.01 pp	65.61%	2041
Writhing Chrysalis	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	9.41 pp	63.09%	19625
Scurry of Gremlins	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	8.79 pp	62.14%	3212
Solitude	Selesnya Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	8.65 pp	63.93%	122
Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	8.64 pp	67.12%	1773
Cranial Ram	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	8.06 pp	61.40%	114
Galvanic Discharge	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	7.78 pp	61.13%	12097
Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	7.51 pp	61.19%	11119

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Brainsurge	Dimir Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	7.44 pp	62.15%	8055

4 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Kozilek's Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	10.0 / 10	23.60 pp	8707
Snapping Voidcraw	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	10.0 / 10	13.64 pp	25353
Izzet Generatorium	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	10.0 / 10	28.47 pp	5639
Sage of the Unknowable	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	9.2 / 10	12.50 pp	18075
Electrozoa	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	6.2 / 10	8.87 pp	7338

5 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Tune the Narrative	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.913	3.67 pp	13753
Roil Cartographer	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.840	5.21 pp	6688
Bespoke Battlewagon	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.722	3.91 pp	6420
Izzet Generatorium	Izzet Cyclops Super-conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.573	-2.65 pp	5935

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Evolution Witness	Selesnya Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	0.335	-0.69 pp	7035
Metastatic Evangel	Selesnya Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	0.335	-1.30 pp	4538
Aether Revolt	Izzet Cyclops Super- conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.280	4.57 pp	3617
Electrozoa	Izzet Cyclops Super- conductor / Tune the Narrative	0.197	1.31 pp	7783
Petrifying Meddler	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	0.187	4.29 pp	23285
Warped Tusker	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	0.176	3.00 pp	18550
Kozilek's Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	0.161	-0.22 pp	9385
Drownyard Lurker	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	0.126	2.39 pp	21682

6 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Writhing Chrysalis	Gruul Eldrazi Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	10.0 / 10	1.70 pp	common
Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	10.0 / 10	2.66 pp	uncommon
Horrific Assault	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	9.9 / 10	1.59 pp	common
Amped Raptor	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	10.0 / 10	2.88 pp	uncommon
Wastescape Battlemage	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcrawl / Drownyard Lurker	9.8 / 10	1.70 pp	uncommon

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Crabomination	Black Base Dream-drinker Vampire / Wither and Bloom	10.0 / 10	3.54 pp	rare
Malevolent Rumble	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	9.8 / 10	1.60 pp	common
Psychic Frog	Dimir Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	10.0 / 10	2.82 pp	rare
Depth Defiler	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	9.7 / 10	1.68 pp	uncommon
Refurbished Familiar	Rakdos Zombies Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	10.0 / 10	1.16 pp	common
Galvanic Discharge	Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	10.0 / 10	1.68 pp	common
Deem Inferior	Dimir Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	10.0 / 10	1.10 pp	common

7 Most Striking Positive Pairs

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Roil Cartographer, Tune the Narrative	Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	1.81	66.07%	2019
Aether Revolt, Bespoke Battlewagon	Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	1.46	68.27%	498
Kozilek's Unsealing, Petrifying Meddler	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	1.27	62.24%	2058
Bespoke Battlewagon, Izzet Generatorium	Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	1.08	60.64%	912
Kozilek's Unsealing, Warped Tusker	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	0.93	60.72%	1721
Aether Revolt, Izzet Generatorium	Izzet Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	0.87	61.90%	504

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Evolution Witness, Metastatic Evangel	Selesnya Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxil- iary	0.80	61.47%	462
Izzet Generatorium, Roil Cartographer	Izzet Cyclops Supercon- ductor / Tune the Narra- tive	0.80	60.63%	894
Kozilek’s Unsealing, Snapping Voidcraw	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	0.60	57.34%	2234
Drownyard Lurker, Kozilek’s Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	0.60	58.94%	2114
Electrozoa, Izzet Generatorium	Izzet Cyclops Supercon- ductor / Tune the Narra- tive	0.49	56.89%	1037
Sage of the Unknowable, Snapping Voidcraw	Simic Eldrazi Snapping Voidcraw / Drownyard Lurker	0.25	54.21%	4560

8 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pair	Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Reckless Pyrosurfer, Thriving Skyclaw	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.84	46.40%	500
Nyxborn Unicorn, Reckless Pyrosurfer	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.67	48.72%	819
Jolted Awake, Reckless Pyrosurfer	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.55	48.85%	479
Hexgold Slith, Jolted Awake	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.51	50.50%	1101
Ondu Knotmaster, Signature Slam	Black Base Dream- drinker Vampire / Wither and Bloom	0.49	45.56%	90
Conduit Goblin, Hexgold Slith	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.45	53.21%	4063
Hexgold Slith, Reckless Pyrosurfer	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.43	49.84%	955
Mandibular Kite, Nyxborn Unicorn	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.43	51.86%	1826
Static Prison, Wing It	Boros Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.42	51.89%	397

Pair		Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Expanding Ooze, Ondu Knotmaster		Black Base Dream-drinker Vampire / Wither and Bloom	0.40	46.24%	346

9 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. The strongest cards show up in the bomb table because they win on their own. The cards that pull a cluster together show up in the build-around and dependency tables because they need a shell. The pair and anti-synergy sections then explain which combinations reinforce a winning plan and which combinations look attractive in draft but underperform together.